

Reading Skill

"Reading is to the mind what exercise is to the body."

- Joseph Addison

2.1 Introduction

Reading is one of the most important language skills. It helps us to gain knowledge, develop our thinking ability and understand the world around us. It is not just about reading words, but about understanding the meaning, analysing the ideas and relating them to real life. Good reading skills improve vocabulary, concentration, imagination and decision-making ability. In academic as well as professional life, reading is essential because it provides us with new information, different perspectives and solutions to problems. With regular practice, we can become better readers and use the information in a meaningful way.

2.2 What is an Unseen Passage ?

An unseen passage is a short piece of writing (prose or poetry) that is not given in the textbook. It is called 'unseen' because the reader has not seen it before. The passage is followed by questions to test the reader's comprehension, vocabulary and grammar. These questions may include one-word substitution, prefixes, suffixes, synonyms, antonyms, true/false, multiple choice questions and short or long answers. The main purpose of an unseen passage is to check how well the reader can understand, interpret and analyse the given text.

Features of an Unseen Passage :

- It is a short and self-contained text.
- It may be factual, descriptive, narrative or argumentative.
- It is not given in the textbook.
- It is followed by comprehension questions.
- It tests vocabulary, grammar and understanding.
- It helps in improving reading and analytical skills.



Good Readers
Make a
Better
Tomorrow

"The more you read, the more things you know.
The more you learn, the more places you'll go."

- Dr. Seuss

2.3 Unseen Passage for Comprehension

Passage - 1

The Value of Trees

Trees are one of the greatest gifts of nature. They not only make our environment clean and green but also provide us with many essentials for life. Trees absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen, which helps in maintaining a healthy atmosphere. They also prevent soil erosion, provide shelter for birds and animals and maintain the ecological balance. In addition, trees give us fruits, wood, medicines and shade. Despite their importance, trees are being cut down at an alarming rate due to urbanisation and industrialisation. If we do not take steps to protect them, future generations may face severe consequences such as climate change, loss of biodiversity and shortage of natural resources. It is the responsibility of every individual to plant more trees and contribute towards a greener and healthier planet.



"Plant a tree today for a better tomorrow."

A. One-word Substitution (from the passage)

1. Things that are necessary for life → _____
2. To keep something in proper balance → _____
3. The gradual increase of towns and cities → _____
4. Extremely serious or worrying → _____
5. The natural home of a living organism → _____

Remember :

- Read the passage carefully.
- Look for exact words in the passage.
- The one-word should match the meaning given in the question.

B. Prefixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the prefix 'un-' → _____
2. Find a word with the prefix 're-' → _____
3. Find a word with the prefix 'in-' or 'im-' → _____

Common Prefixes :

un- (not)	re- (again)
in-/im- (not)	dis- (opposite)
pre- (before)	non- (not)

C. Suffixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the suffix '-tion' → _____
2. Find a word with the suffix '-ness' → _____
3. Find a word with the suffix '-ful' or '-less' → _____

Common Suffixes :

-tion (action)	-ness (state)
-ful (full of)	-less (without)
-ment (result)	-ing (process)

D. Synonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word similar in meaning to 'serious' → _____
2. Find a word similar in meaning to 'protect' → _____
3. Find a word similar in meaning to 'shortage' → _____

Synonyms help to :

- Improve vocabulary
- Understand the text better
- Express the same idea in different words

E. Antonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'harmful' → _____
2. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'increase' → _____
3. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'natural' → _____

Antonyms help to :

- Understand contrast in meaning
- Improve word power

"A Greener Tomorrow depends on what we do Today."

2.3 Unseen Passage for Comprehension

Practice Passage - 1

Passage : The Power of Technology

Technology has become an integral part of our daily lives. It has changed the way we communicate, learn, work and even think. With the help of the internet and mobile devices, we can connect with people across the world within seconds. Online education has made learning more accessible, and digital platforms have created new opportunities for business and employment. However, excessive use of technology can also have negative effects. It may lead to a sedentary lifestyle, reduce face-to-face interaction and cause distractions. Therefore, it is important to use technology wisely and in a balanced way so that we can enjoy its benefits without harming our physical and mental health.



"Use Technology as a Tool, Not a Distraction."

A. One-word Substitution (from the passage)

1. A device that can be carried easily → _____
2. Able to be reached or obtained easily → _____
3. Not moving much → _____
4. Something that prevents you from giving full attention → _____
5. Using something in a sensible and careful way → _____

Key Words from Passage :

- integral
- communicate
- accessible
- opportunities
- excessive
- distractions
- balanced
- benefits

B. Prefixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the prefix 'in-' → _____
2. Find a word with the prefix 'dis-' → _____
3. Find a word with the prefix 'ex-' → _____

Common Prefixes :

- in- (not)
- dis- (opposite)
- re- (again)
- un- (not)
- pre- (before)
- over- (more than)

C. Suffixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the suffix '-tion' → _____
2. Find a word with the suffix '-ment' → _____
3. Find a word with the suffix '-ly' → _____

Common Suffixes :

- -tion (action)
- -ment (result)
- -ly (in a manner)
- -ful (full of)
- -less (without)
- -ness (state)

D. Synonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word similar in meaning to 'important' → _____
2. Find a word similar in meaning to 'quick' → _____
3. Find a word similar in meaning to 'advantages' → _____

E. Antonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'positive' → _____
2. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'increase' → _____
3. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'accessible' → _____

Reading is not just about words, but about understanding the world around you.